LOW TIDE RADIO

SIDES
Shoot Day 1 · Mon 11 Jan 2027
LOW TIDE RADIO: Shooting Draft (Locked)

CREW CALL: 07:00

LOCATION
Coast Radio Station (Old Signal Station, Vypin), Beach Road, Vypin, Kochi, Kerala 682508

CAST

CHARACTER	ACTOR	CALL
SURESH	Sajan Kuriakose	Needs input
RAHUL	Aditya Nair	Needs input
ANJALI	Nimisha Raghavan	Needs input
JOE	Lal Fernandez	Needs input

NOTES
Coast Radio Station interiors, day. Basement water pumped from 05:00.

Created with OpenFrame Studio

27 INT. COAST RADIO STATION - TAPE ROOM - DAY 27

A basement under the operations room, down a concrete stair. Black water stands knee-deep. Daylight falls through a single grille in one slanting bar. Swollen tape boxes float everywhere, open and empty.

Anjali wades in wearing rubber boots, a torch in her hand. Rahul follows in shorts and a head torch. Suresh stays at the top of the stairs in his site boots, a hard hat in his hand.

SURESH
Mind the wiring. There's no power, but mind it anyway.

Anjali pushes a floating box aside. Empty. Another. Empty.

RAHUL
What are we looking for?

ANJALI
Appachan said they'd bury the room.
(she looks up at the ceiling)
I thought he meant upstairs.

ANGLE ON THE UNDERSIDE OF THE CONCRETE STAIRS, BLACK AND DRIPPING. SOMETHING SQUARE AND OLIVE GREEN IS BOLTED UP UNDER THE TREADS.

Rahul crouches until the water reaches his waist and ducks under the stairs.

RAHUL
Chechi. There's a box.

An army surplus ammunition box, bolted under the stairs with two rusted brackets. A padlock.

SURESH
(coming down three steps)
That's a fuse box.

RAHUL
It's an ammunition box. My uncle keeps his fish hooks in one.

Anjali pulls the coir string of keys from under her shirt. One key. Another. The third is small and brass, newer than the rest. It turns.

Together she and Rahul ease the box off its brackets. She holds it up clear of the water.

Suresh comes the rest of the way down into the water without seeming to notice he has done it.

She sets the box on a step and lifts the lid. A rubber seal sighs. Inside, dry, wrapped in a plastic rice sack, a ledger bound in green cloth. Stencilled on the cover: KDK Coast Radio. Station Log. 1999.

Nobody speaks.

28 INT. COAST RADIO STATION - OPERATIONS ROOM - DAY 28

Daylight through the broken shutters across the old desk. Anjali sits where her mother sat, the logbook open. Rahul perches on the desk. Suresh stands at the window, not quite in the room.

The pages are ruled in columns: time, station, traffic, operator. A different hand for each shift. Anjali turns to the fourteenth of November and runs her finger down.

ANJALI
(reading)
Eighteen hundred. Mariamma on watch.

18:00 M. THOMAS ON WATCH. WEATHER TO ALL STATIONS. WIND W 20 KNOTS AND RISING.

21:30 ELEVEN BOATS AT SEA, ALL REPORTING: LITTLE FLOWER, SEAGULL, MORNING STAR, BISMILLAH, SEA QUEEN, AMBADI, JYOTHI, MOTHER MARY, ST. ANTONY, KAIRALI, POURNAMI.

22:50 CYCLONE WARNING RELAYED FROM DISTRICT. ALL BOATS ADVISED TO RETURN.

23:15 LITTLE FLOWER AND SEAGULL REPORT HEAVY SWELL, 9 MILES WSW.

23:32 SEAGULL NOT ANSWERING. LITTLE FLOWER STANDING BY.

ANJALI (CONT'D)
Twenty-three thirty-two. Seagull not answering.

Her finger stops. The next entry is in another hand, heavier, pressed hard into the paper.

23:40 MAIN POWER CUT BY ORDER. J. D'CRUZ.

Suresh crosses the room in three steps and reads it over her shoulder.

SURESH
By order.

ANJALI
It doesn't say storm damage.

Below Joe's line, in the round quick hand from the reel label, a single small entry.

23:41 ON BATTERY.

ANJALI (CONT'D)
(almost a whisper)
On battery.

RAHUL
What does that mean?

ANJALI
It means somebody switched her off, and she didn't stay off.

Suresh puts his hard hat down on the desk as if it were made of glass. He looks at the doorway.

SURESH
Joe D'Cruz said it was the storm. He said it to my mother in our front room. He held her hand when he said it.

Anjali closes the logbook and stands.

ANJALI
Where does he drink now?

SURESH
Same place he always did.

CUT TO: